

while open markets and international market access support Switzerland's ability to compete. In digital assets, maintaining this position also requires renewed domestic momentum and stronger links between the crypto ecosystem and Swiss banking.

4.6 What Day 3 Established

Day 3 showed how innovation can extend Switzerland's existing financial capabilities. Crypto Valley initially grew from regulatory and political openness, legal expertise, and a dedicated community, before developing across several Swiss regions. Volkov described how traditional and crypto-native finance are converging as institutions adopt shared services and infrastructure. Lusenti and Ferrari connected institutional investment to liabilities, investment horizons, governance, and client needs. Dori showed that institutional access to digital assets requires regulated infrastructure, continuous operations, and an analysis of the risks specific to each use case. Across all these examples, innovation becomes valuable when specialist expertise can operate within credible institutions and serve defined financial needs.

The closing panel situated these capabilities within a more competitive international environment. Bailly and Volkov called for continued adaptation in regulation, entrepreneurship, and access to talent. Lusenti identified Switzerland's limited size and capital market as constraints, while Ferrari stressed education, client proximity, and the ability to finance innovative companies. Ahmed placed greater emphasis on consistency. The speakers nevertheless agreed on one point: Switzerland can compete through specialization, high-value activities, institutional stability, and the application of new technologies to established capabilities. Maintaining these advantages requires ongoing decisions about regulation, talent, capital, market access, and innovation.

4.6 What Day 3 Established

Speakers

Sheraz Ahmed & Jérôme Bailly

Takeaway 1

Crypto Valley emerged from openness to early crypto projects and a community that developed around them.

Takeaway 2

Switzerland's crypto ecosystem is geographically distributed, with Zug, Zurich, Geneva, Lugano, and Neuchâtel developing different roles.

Takeaway 3

The next phase requires stronger links with Swiss banking, together with renewed alignment between the industry, regulators, and political authorities.

Ilya Volkov

Takeaway 1

Traditional and crypto-native finance are converging, as they each incorporate services and infrastructure developed by the other.

Ilya Volkov

Takeaway 2

Technology should follow the use case: Payments, investments, and trading involve different functions and risks, regardless of the underlying infrastructure.

Takeaway 3

Centralized and decentralized finance can coexist, with users choosing different combinations of institutional services, self-custody, and blockchain infrastructure.

Graziano Lusenti & Olivier Ferrari

Takeaway 1

Institutional investment starts with obligations, client needs, and investment horizons, which determine how assets should be allocated.

Takeaway 2

Sustainability belongs within long-term investment decisions, with governance and environmental considerations assessed alongside the institution's obligations.

4.6 What Day 3 Established

Speakers

Graziano Lusenti & Olivier Ferrari

Takeaway 3

Independent investment firms compete through client focus and specialization, while Switzerland must preserve its stability and improve its capacity to finance and retain innovative companies.

Fabian Dori

Takeaway 1

Digital-asset banks provide the regulated value chain for institutional access, combining infrastructure, compliance, and 24/7 operations.

Takeaway 2

Institutional demand is moving from speculative returns towards diversification and portfolio resilience, with each digital-asset use case carrying different value and risk drivers.

Takeaway 3

CeFi and DeFi will coexist, serving investors with different risk profiles and levels of expertise. CeFi provides institutional intermediation and custody, while DeFi allows investors to access decentralized protocols directly and assume greater responsibility.

Day 3 panel

Takeaway 1

Switzerland retains important advantages, including stability, trust, financial expertise, talent, and an established capacity for innovation.

Takeaway 2

The speakers disagreed about how much adaptation is required: Some called for changes in regulation, capital, immigration, and entrepreneurship, while others stressed the value of consistency.

Takeaway 3

Switzerland should compete through quality and specialization rather than scale, with new technologies extending capabilities already present in its financial system.

Day 3 established innovation as an extension of existing capabilities and a sine qua non pillar of prosperity and competitiveness. While Switzerland possesses durable institutions and specialist capabilities, their value depends on how they are applied to current client and market problems. Day 4 therefore involved taking a look inside portfolios and the operating model of wealth managers. Participants examined how AI, digital assets, tokenization, and DeFi affect investment decisions, portfolio construction, execution, reporting, and risk control.



5

Wealth Management 3.0 in Practice

Day 4 involved a move from market structure to implementation. A portfolio is not necessarily better because it contains digital assets, uses artificial intelligence, or produces more data. The relevant question is whether a new instrument or tool improves portfolio construction, reveals risk, expands useful access, reduces operational friction, or strengthens the client's understanding and control. The interviews on Day 4 applied this logic to digital-asset allocation, machine learning, AI-assisted research and reporting, and DeFi infrastructure. They also exposed the limits of technological sophistication: Models depend on data, tokenization does not in itself create liquidity, automation does not eliminate accountability, and decentralized systems remain vulnerable to security and execution risks. Wealth Management 3.0 therefore appears here as an operating discipline, rather than a catalogue of technologies: Innovation has value when it improves a defined investment or client function.



5.1 Inside a Portfolio in 2026 with Florian Lefort

Florian Lefort, portfolio manager at Capitelia Invest, described wealth management in 2026 as a profession that is in the process of adapting to digital assets, tokenization, and artificial intelligence. Portfolio managers must understand these developments, assess their investment consequences, and be able to explain them to clients.

Lefort considers digital assets suitable for diversified portfolios when the allocation matches the client's risk profile. He suggests an exposure of 1 to 5% that is calibrated to the client's risk appetite and always situated within a broader diversification framework. Exposure can include cryptocurrencies as well as companies involved in mining, security, trading, and custody. He also distinguishes the functions of various digital assets: Bitcoin has developed a store-of-value function, stablecoins represent assets such as the US dollar on blockchain networks, and network assets such as Ether pay transaction fees. Tokenization can be used to extend the same infrastructure to traditional assets. A tokenized money-market fund, for example, can represent a fund share, trade outside conventional market hours, and potentially serve as collateral in decentralized finance.

Institutional infrastructure shapes how these assets enter portfolios. Lefort emphasized Switzerland's regulated digital-asset ecosystem, as well as the role of banks and custodians in deciding which assets they support. He sees this filtering as a way to reduce counterparty and operational risks. However, it does not remove market risk. Digital assets remain volatile, meaning that advisers must understand both the nature of the assets themselves and their risks before recommending them.

Artificial intelligence is changing the entire investment process and not simply the asset universe alone. Lefort already uses AI for research, sector analysis, and customized reporting. Automation can reduce the need for manual data work, leaving more time for analysis. Lefort's point with regard to reporting is that it should become simpler as the portfolio becomes more complex. He looks for a form of reporting that answers three questions: why the portfolio made gains or losses, what risk was taken, and whether it is still appropriate to the client's situation. The elements that he most often finds missing are the contribution each

pocket makes to risk rather than to performance, the portfolio's real liquidity, and, in cases involving Lombard loans, the collateral and coverage ratios. The data he wants in real time is the real liquidity of each position under stress and not the liquidity described in a prospectus. In his view, the problem is not a lack of data but its dispersion. He also notes that permanent liquidity brings permanent temptation: Client behavior remains the primary source of risk for the portfolio.

Lefort expects automation to lead to a shift in human work toward judgment and client interaction, rather than eliminating the need for advisers. He connected this role to independent Swiss wealth managers, who can select investments across the market rather than from a restricted product range. The test he uses for technology is practical: Managers should understand it, determine where it improves investment or client service, and explain its use. He views artificial intelligence in the first instance as a productivity shock, one which represents an opportunity rather than a threat for investors, and applies the same approach to AI-related investments: Rather than seeking out the companies that are developing the technology, he looks for its indirect beneficiaries—i.e., those companies that will capture the productivity gains it unlocks. These gains will extend to entire industries well beyond technology. Businesses in the logistics, industrial, healthcare, and service sectors can become structurally more profitable without ever being classified as technology companies, and the market has not yet repriced them as beneficiaries. Innovation changes both the kinds of investments available to wealth managers and the tools they use to manage them.

5.2 Building Robust Portfolios with Frank Crittin

Frank Crittin, Chief Investment Officer at MFM Mirante Fund Management, described portfolio management as an increasingly integrated combination of fundamental judgment, mathematics, and technology. Although fundamental and quantitative specialists once worked largely in isolation from one another, Crittin now views fundamental analysis, quantitative methods, and technology as complementary components of a single investment process.

Crittin began by acknowledging a limit: Financial systems are too complex to allow for reliable predictions. Portfolio management should therefore focus less on attempting to foresee every event or timing markets and more on building portfolios that can withstand a variety of conditions. This requires the wealth manager to analyze individual investments, their weighting, and how assets behave together.

Traditional correlation and covariance matrices remain essential tools for measuring these relationships, but the estimates they produce can be unstable and highly dependent on the period and data used. MFM is exploring machine-learning methods, including Gaussian processes, that allow the team to work with distributions of possible outcomes rather than a single optimal or expected result. The firm has also used mathematical tools from topology to identify similarities and structural relationships between assets. Crittin presented these methods as ways to improve portfolio robustness in the face of uncertainty.

This reasoning also informs his take on the traditional 60/40 portfolio. Equities and bonds remain important sources of long-term returns, but he considers a portfolio that is limited to them excessively restrictive. The inclusion of alternative strategies, commodities, small-cap equities, and cryptocurrencies can add different return drivers. Cryptocurrencies, for their part, remain volatile and have a shorter track record, which makes it harder to calibrate strategies and measure their effect within a multi-asset portfolio. MFM is currently developing a multi-asset strategy that includes cryptocurrencies. Crittin argued that their contribution should be assessed within the context of the portfolio as a whole rather than as standalone assets.

AI is also accelerating investment research. MFM uses it to examine a broader universe of companies and process information more systematically, while preserving the need for human validation and investment judgment. Crittin described this evolution in terms of the industrialization and scaling of parts of the fundamental research process. As these tools become widely available, he expects differentiation to shift toward portfolio construction, machine-learning research, and the investment systems firms build around them. This development in turn depends on data quality. Crittin argued that AI cannot be applied effectively to portfolio construction without the required data and a well-structured database.

Investment teams therefore need not only financial knowledge, but also coding, database, and technology skills. Client trust remains central.

Managers must first understand the needs, investment horizons, and risk tolerance of their clients, before explaining the strategies they recommend. According to Crittin, a black-box investment process is unlikely to sustain trust over time: Managers must explain what they do, measure the results, and justify their decisions. AI-generated research also requires verification. Technology can significantly expand a manager's analytical capacity, but it does not replace investment judgement, responsibility, or client understanding. Ultimately, trust depends on the manager's ability to make the investment process both rigorous and intelligible.

5.3 Applying AI to Wealth Management

Robin Lemann, Head Institutional Sales and Partners Business at Swissquote Bank, and Dr. Andreas Janoschek, Founder and CEO of Gerevest.AI, described how artificial intelligence is changing administration, investment analysis, reporting, compliance, and client service. While AI can increase the amount of work wealth managers perform and reduce the time required for specific tasks, human review and responsibility remain an essential part of the process.

Lemann has identified immediate applications in administration, analytics, reporting and compliance, as AI is able to help with KYC checks, transaction monitoring, periodic reviews, and onboarding. At Swissquote, Yuhlia analyzes information from a client's Yuh account and provides information about spending, returns, diversification risks, and financial organization. Swissquote also uses AI to produce internal materials and is developing a tool to reduce preliminary work in onboarding and compliance. These efficiency gains can leave employees more time for clients.

Dr. Janoschek and his company Gerevest.AI help wealth managers to implement AI securely. One of his key focal points is investment analysis. Large institutions traditionally employed specialist analysts to cover different markets and asset classes. Now, AI allows smaller wealth managers to create analytical tools that enable them to cover more markets and asset classes. It can also automate data collection and client reporting. At the same time, Dr. Janoschek recommended that a

human always review AI-generated reporting before it reaches the client. This is particularly important under the EU AI Act, as its transparency rules dictate that fully automated reporting must be labeled as such.

AI and machine learning can also be used to identify portfolio risks. A portfolio may contain different funds and asset classes, while retaining common underlying exposures. Machine-learning tools make it possible analyze asset behavior and identify risks that are not immediately visible. Dr. Janoschek also emphasized the risks associated with automated trading systems operating without human oversight. The COVID-19 market shock demonstrated how rigid algorithmic rules can trigger automatic sell-offs, followed by a rapid recovery. As current AI systems have not yet undergone a similar stress test, it remains an open question whether they will also exhibit a herd mentality.

Human judgment continues to be of central importance in client relationships and investment decisions. Lemann argued that while technology can provide faster access to knowledge and analysis, trust develops on the basis of human relationships. In his opinion, human being are ultimately responsible for financial advice. Dr. Janoschek drew the same conclusion: Responsibility for a client portfolio remains with the bank, wealth manager, or portfolio manager. He also identified a new analytical problem. Financial professionals—and their clients—face information overload (including from AI-generated content) and must determine what is relevant and reliable.

AI can adapt reporting to individual clients. Reports can use the client's language and be adjusted to their level of technical understanding. The appropriate frequency also depends on the client. Some investors want to be immediately informed of developments, while others delegate responsibility for their portfolios, because they do not want to be constantly receiving alerts. Dr. Janoschek is convinced that AI is particularly beneficial to smaller firms by providing them with high-level capabilities that were at one time only available to the largest institutions. Lemann identified another change as well: Banks, AI companies, and financial-data platforms may compete to aggregate financial information and provide AI-supported analysis.

AI can increase analytical coverage, automate operational work, and adapt information to suit individual clients. Moreover, smaller firms can use these capabilities to reduce some advantages of institutional scale. Nonetheless, human review remains indispensable for investment



decisions and client communication, while the ultimate responsibility continues to lie with the financial institution and the professionals it employs.

5.4 DeFi Infrastructure for Humans and AI Agents

Jean Rausis, co-founder of Everything, described decentralized finance, using an example, in terms of a protocol designed to combine trading, lending, borrowing, and leverage within a single liquidity system. His argument focused on fragmentation, execution by AI agents, and the security limits of DeFi.

Everything developed from SmarDex, which was originally a decentralized exchange. Rausis described DeFi as replacing reliance on an intermediary with reliance on auditable code. He argued that DeFi is currently fragmented: Users often move between separate protocols for different functions, while liquidity remains distributed across contracts and may not be fully exploited. Everything therefore seeks to integrate swaps, lending, borrowing, and leverage within a single architecture. Rausis also sees simpler interfaces as necessary for broader adoption. Users should be able to access decentralized services without understanding each underlying protocol.

This unified architecture also underpins his approach to artificial intelligence. Rausis expressed doubts that autonomous agents can reliably manage money across fragmented DeFi markets when execution is not deterministic: Liquidity can change, protocols can fail, and an agent may open a position without knowing whether comparable liquidity will exist when it needs to exit. Everything is designed to reduce these uncertainties. Rausis described Eva, its AI agent, as analyzing blockchain activity and calculating answers from on-chain information. For certain positions, the protocol is intended to secure the liquidity required for the exit when the position is opened, thus creating a more predictable execution environment.

Rausis did not claim that architecture removes risk. Smart-contract transactions are irreversible, and he made clear that no system can be declared completely secure. Everything has therefore invested in audits and offered a large bug bounty. He attributed many DeFi failures to